dimensions to our cooperation.” He managed to steer Trump towards the larger structural realities that have driven the India–US relationship since George W. Bush declared that America would help India emerge as a global power. Trump’s South Asia strategy has also taken Indian concerns into account, and his emphasis on the “Indo-Pacific” is in tune with Indian thinking. With the signing of limited access pacts and a growing panoply of joint military training exercises, India and the United States have been moving towards moderate alignment per the framework articulated by the editors of this volume.

Indian foreign policy is undergoing a gradual transformation under Modi, and changing Indo–US ties are one of the most significant manifestations of this trend. Modi’s success or failure in reconfiguring Indo–US ties will determine the future trajectory of Indian foreign policy in many ways. New Delhi is showing signs of pursuing strategic autonomy separately from non-alignment under Modi. This separation is overdue in India’s foreign policy, and the country stands to benefit from leveraging partnerships rather than shunning them. In fact, this has provided New Delhi with greater flexibility to move along the wider spectrum of alignments in its foreign policy. India today is charting new territory in its foreign policy, predicated on the belief that rather than proclaiming non-alignment as an end in itself, India needs deeper engagement with its friends and partners if it is to develop leverage in its dealings with its adversaries and competitors. At present, India is well positioned to define its bilateral relationships on its own terms without ideological crutches.

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